



RICHARDSON POLICE DEPARTMENT PUBLIC SAFETY CADETS

PROBATIONARY PROGRAM



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WELCOME

Welcome to the Richardson Police Department Public Safety Cadets. The Cadet Program is designed to provide young adults with the opportunity to learn about law enforcement, develop leadership skills, and serve their community. Through training, hands-on activities, and mentorship from law enforcement professionals, Cadets gain valuable experience and insight into the responsibilities and expectations of a career in public safety.

All new members enter the program as probationary Cadets for a period of six months. The purpose of this probationary period is to ensure that each new Cadet understands the standards, responsibilities, and expectations required to represent the Cadet Unit and the department. During this time, probationary members will complete training requirements, demonstrate basic skills, and become familiar with the policies and procedures of the program.

The probationary period is also an opportunity for new Cadets to determine whether the program is a good fit for them. Cadets will be expected to demonstrate professionalism, maintain a positive attitude, follow the chain of command, and actively participate in meetings, training, and events.

Successful completion of the probationary program indicates that the Cadet has demonstrated the maturity, commitment, and skills necessary to participate as a full member of the Cadet Unit.

We are excited to have you join the program and look forward to helping you develop the knowledge, skills, and leadership abilities that will serve you well in the future.



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TASK OVERVIEW

The table below summarizes every task you must complete during your six-month probationary period, when it should be done, and who signs it off.

#	TASK	COMPLETE BY	RESPONSIBLE	SIGNED OFF BY
1	Receive this Program	Week 1 ___ / ___ / ___	Lieutenant or Sergeant	
2	Submit Liability Waivers	Week 2 ___ / ___ / ___	Lieutenant or Sergeant	
3	Meet with Assigned Squad Sergeant	Week 3 ___ / ___ / ___	Squad Sergeant	
4	Purchase Necessary Uniform Equipment	Week 3 ___ / ___ / ___	Quartermaster	
5	Receive Issued Equipment From Quartermaster	Week 3 ___ / ___ / ___	Quartermaster	
6	Acknowledge Uniform Policies	Week 3 ___ / ___ / ___	Squad Sergeant	
7	Acknowledge Cadet General Orders, Guide Book, and Time Management	Week 3 or whenever assigned ___ / ___ / ___	Squad Sergeant	
8	Demonstrate Basic Skills of Handcuffing and Building Searches	Month 3 ___ / ___ / ___	Squad Sergeant	
9	Demonstrate Ability to Run NCIC Check and Utilize Phonetic Alphabet	Month 4 ___ / ___ / ___	Squad Sergeant	
10	Complete Final Exam	Month 5 ___ / ___ / ___	Lieutenant	



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TASK DETAILS

TASK 1 | RECEIVE THIS PROGRAM

Congratulations for joining the Unit! This program guides you through your first six months as a brand new Richardson Police Cadet. As a probationary Cadet, you are responsible for keeping up with this program and completing all of the tasks listed above. Please join our GroupMe group using the QR code or link below. It is REQUIRED that you read all current announcements, including the requirement to answer all Cadet-related messages.



GroupMe: <https://rpdcadets.com/groupme>

TASK 2 | SUBMIT LIABILITY WAIVERS

As a new Cadet, you must complete the waivers and forms required to participate in the Unit. The complete list of required documents is on the New Cadet Onboarding Checklist. Complete every form on that checklist that applies to you, since some forms differ depending on your age or family situation, and return them to an Advisor.

Some documents must be notarized when signed. These can be notarized for free by a jailer at the Richardson Police Department Jail. The forms can be downloaded from the members area of our website.

Forms: <https://rpdcadets.com/members> (Password: chief761)

TASK 3 | MEET WITH SQUAD SERGEANT

Now that you have been assigned to a squad, it is important to meet with your new Squad Sergeant. They are your first-line supervisor in our chain of command and a great source for resources. You will present yourself to them for inspection, and they will add you to your appropriate squad group chat.



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TASK 4 | PURCHASE NECESSARY UNIFORM EQUIPMENT

As a new Cadet, there is some equipment you will need to purchase on your own.

ITEM	CHECK OFF
Black Polo	☐
Black BDU Pants	☐
Solid Black Polishable Boots	☐
Handcuffs & Key	☐
Flashlight	☐
Silver Nametag (1/2 in x 2 3/8 in)	☐

Nametag format: First Initial, Last Name (example: J. Doe).

All recommendations are for C&G Wholesale, a police supply store with usually good deals. Cadets may also be required to purchase specific models or types; consult the guidebook for the most up-to-date suggestions. If you have financial difficulty and are unable to purchase equipment, reach out to an Advisor.

TASK 5 | RECEIVE ISSUED EQUIPMENT FROM QUARTERMASTER

After purchasing your equipment, you will meet with our Quartermaster to receive uniform shirts, belts, and other equipment. You will typically receive:

- Blue Class B Shirt
- Gray Class B Shirt
- Inner Belt
- Outer Belt
- 4x Belt Keepers
- Blue Gun + Holster
- Blue Taser + Holster
- Handcuff Pouch
- Miranda Card
- Radio Codes Sheet



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TASK 6 | ACKNOWLEDGE UNIFORM POLICIES

As part of the Richardson Police Department Cadet Unit, you are bound to the same uniform standards that officers and civilian employees follow. This is important because you represent the Unit and the Richardson Police Department. The Admin Sergeant or Lieutenant will explain the uniform rules, and you must read the uniform section in our guidebook and uniform presentation.

Uniform Policies: https://rpdcadets.com/Uniform_Quick_Reference.pdf

TASK 7 | ACKNOWLEDGE CADET GENERAL ORDERS, GUIDE BOOK, AND TIME MANAGEMENT

As a new Cadet, you are responsible for reading the General Orders that relate to the Cadet Unit, our Unit guidebook, and understanding time management within the Unit. General Orders are department policies that guide daily operations. Our Unit guidebook serves as a reference for Cadets, and our website holds many useful resources such as forms, guides, and documents.

Cadets are required to maintain a log of their activity at special events so they can receive awards for their service. Our website has a page dedicated to logging time. Cadets are also required to use the calendar function on our GroupMe to indicate whether they will attend meetings or events.

General Orders: <https://rpdcadets.com/go>

Cadet Guidebook: <https://rpdcadets.com/guide>

Website Files: <https://rpdcadets.com/members> (Password: chief761)

Time Entry: <https://rpdcadets.com/trackers> (Password: chief761)

TASK 8 | DEMONSTRATE BASIC SKILLS OF HANDCUFFING AND BUILDING SEARCHES

At the halfway point of your probationary period, you will meet with your Squad Sergeant to demonstrate the basic skills of handcuffing and building searches. These are important fundamental skills. Feel free to ask your supervisor for help practicing them beforehand if you need it.



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TASK 9 | DEMONSTRATE ABILITY TO RUN NCIC CHECK AND UTILIZE PHONETIC ALPHABET

As you near the end of your probation, you must be able to run an NCIC check for scenarios and demonstrate the phonetic alphabet while doing so. You will meet with your Squad Sergeant to demonstrate these skills.

Phonetic Alphabet

A - Adam	J - John	S - Sam
B - Boy	K - King	T - Tom
C - Charles	L - Lincoln	U - Union
D - David	M - Mary	V - Victor
E - Edward	N - Nora	W - William
F - Frank	O - Ocean	X - X-ray
G - George	P - Paul	Y - Young
H - Henry	Q - Queen	Z - Zebra
I - Ida	R - Robert	

TASK 10 | COMPLETE FINAL EXAM

In the last month of probation, you will schedule a meeting with the Cadet Lieutenant to be inspected and complete a short exam. The exam can cover:

- This document and the Cadet guidebook
- Chain of command and supervisory structure
- Required uniform and equipment standards
- Meeting attendance and notification procedures
- Communication expectations and GroupMe usage
- Radio communication procedures
- Volunteer hour responsibilities
- Basic legal concepts, including Frisk vs. Search and Arrest vs. Detention